

BSc (Hons) in **Computer Science**

Faculty of Computing

SE3062 : Intelligent Systems

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026

Practical 07

> **Module Objective:** In previous weeks, your Drow Ranger agent used A* Search to find a physical path to the goal. However, it blindly assumed every non-wall tile was safe. Today, we implement a **Knowledge Base (KB)** and a **Forward Chaining Inference Engine**. Your agent must now mathematically prove a cell is logically *Feasible* before taking a step, using real-time rules about map vision and enemy threats.

> **Before you start:** This lab continues the project from Labs 1–4. Open the same project and check that `SearchAgent.astar_search()` in `agent.py` works.
>
> - Parts 1, 2 & 4: new files (`logic_engine.py` , `test_logic.py`) in the project folder.
> - Part 3: edit your existing `agent.py` .
> - **Create a separate branch `lab-07`** and start your work there. When finished, **commit your code and push the branch**, as you did in Labs 1–4.
> - **Upload this worksheet's answered PDF to the submission portal.**

Part 1: The Logic Engine Architecture

Step 1.1: Building the Knowledge Base (KB)

> Instead of hardcoding hundreds of nested `if-else` statements in our agent's movement logic, we will build a declarative Knowledge Base. You need to design a Python class that stores **Facts** (current percepts) and **Rules** (Horn Clauses).

1. Create a new file named `logic_engine.py` .
2. Implement a `KnowledgeBase` class based on the following structural requirements:

```
CLASS KnowledgeBase:
    // Attributes
    DECLARE facts AS Set                    // To store unique string f
    DECLARE rules AS List                   // To store rules as Tuples
```

```
// Methods
FUNCTION tell_fact(fact_string):
    ADD fact_string TO facts

FUNCTION tell_rule(premise_list, conclusion_string):
    APPEND Tuple(premise_list, conclusion_string) TO rules

FUNCTION clear_facts():
    EMPTY the facts Set
```

Part 2: Implementing Forward Chaining

Step 2.1: The Inference Algorithm

> The agent needs an Inference Engine to deduce new information from its raw sensors. Translate the following Data-Driven **Forward Chaining** algorithm into a Python method inside your `KnowledgeBase` class.

1. Write the `forward_chain()` method.
2. Ensure you use a `while` loop that continues to iterate over the rules until a full pass results in absolutely no new facts being deduced.

```
FUNCTION forward_chain():
   DECLARE new_facts_added = TRUE

   WHILE new_facts_added == TRUE:
       new_facts_added = FALSE

       FOR EACH (premises, conclusion) IN rules:
           IF conclusion IS NOT IN facts:

               // Modus Ponens Check
               IF ALL premises ARE IN facts:
                   ADD conclusion TO facts
                   new_facts_added = TRUE
```

Part 3: Hooking Logic into the Grid Game

Step 3.1: Defining the Game Constraints

> Now we translate the game's safety constraints into our logic engine using Propositional Logic.

1. In `agent.py`, add `from logic_engine import KnowledgeBase`, then create the KB in `SearchAgent.__init__`: `self.kb = KnowledgeBase()`.
2. Use your `tell_rule` method to define the following safety rules:
   Rule 1: `TargetVisible ∧ HasDust ⇒ SafeToEngage`
   Rule 2: `SafeToEngage ∧ BloodseekerMissing ⇒ Retreat`

The game does not produce these facts, so you supply them per tile as a dictionary: `{(x, y): [facts]}`. A tile where `Retreat` is deduced is unsafe to enter.

Step 3.2: Validating Feasibility in A*

> Modify your existing A* pathfinding algorithm to consult the Knowledge Base before expanding a node.

1. Add a parameter `tile_facts=None` to `astar_search()` (treat `None` as `{}`).
2. Locate the neighbor-generation loop in your A* code (where you normally check for physical walls).
3. Before adding a neighbor to the `open_list`, clear the KB facts.
4. Feed that tile's facts into the KB: `for fact in tile_facts.get(successor, []): self.kb.tell_fact(fact)`.
5. Run `self.kb.forward_chain()`.
6. If `'Retreat'` is deduced and exists in `self.kb.facts`, mark the tile as **Infeasible**. Skip it (do not add it to the open list), even if it is physically reachable.

Step 3.3: Run It in the Grid

1. In `sense_and_act()`, define sample facts and pass them to A*:

```
tile_facts = {
   (1, 0): ['TargetVisible', 'HasDust', 'BloodseekerMissing'],  # d
   (0, 1): ['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'],                        # S
```

```
}
self.plan = self.astar_search(position, nearest_food, walls, grid_si
```

2. Run `visual_grid_game.py`. The agent should never step onto `(1, 0)`.

Part 4: Self-Evaluation Test Cases

4.1 Automated Validation

Create a file named `test_logic.py`. Copy and run the following Python assert statements to verify your Forward Chaining engine works correctly mathematically before you attempt to integrate it into the visual grid.

```
from logic_engine import KnowledgeBase

def test_forward_chaining():
    kb = KnowledgeBase()

    # Add Domain Rules
    kb.tell_rule(['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'], 'SafeToEngage')
    kb.tell_rule(['SafeToEngage', 'BloodseekerMissing'], 'Retreat')

    # Test Case 1: Safe Engagement
    kb.clear_facts()
    kb.tell_fact('TargetVisible')
    kb.tell_fact('HasDust')
    kb.forward_chain()
    assert 'SafeToEngage' in kb.facts, "Test 1 Failed: Should deduce
    assert 'Retreat' not in kb.facts, "Test 1 Failed: Should NOT ded

    # Test Case 2: Unsafe Engagement (Bloodseeker Missing)
    kb.clear_facts()
    kb.tell_fact('TargetVisible')
    kb.tell_fact('HasDust')
    kb.tell_fact('BloodseekerMissing')
    kb.forward_chain()
    assert 'Retreat' in kb.facts, "Test 2 Failed: Should deduce Retr

    print("✅ All Logic Engine Test Cases Passed!")
```

```
if __name__ == "__main__":
    test_forward_chaining()
```

Part 5: Theory-to-Implementation Mapping

> Based on the code you just wrote and the lecture on Logical Reasoning, complete the following analytical questions to explain *how* your code implements the theory.

1. Reachability vs. Feasibility (Apply)
In Step 3.2, you modified the A* algorithm's neighbor-generation loop. How does your new code differentiate between checking if a node is "Reachable" (like a wall collision) versus checking if it is "Feasible"? Explain how the Knowledge Base enforces feasibility.

Reachability determines whether the successor node is physically capable of being reached such as by ensuring that it lies within the grid and is not a wall. Feasibility determines whether it is feasible for the agent to enter that reachability tile based on the logic based safety requirements of the agent.
In checking every successor the agent removes the knowledge base facts and then adds the facts provided by the tile after which "forward_chain()" is called. If "Retreat" exists among the new facts then the successor is deemed infeasible and is ignored.

2. Declarative vs. Procedural Paradigms (Analyze)
Why did we build a `KnowledgeBase` class with a `forward_chain()` loop instead of simply writing `if 'TargetVisible' in percepts and 'HasDust' in percepts:` directly inside the agent's movement code? What happens to the agent's code complexity if we add 50 new game rules?

The Knowledge Base holds the rules as facts that relate the facts and the "forward_chain()" function represents one way of doing inference using the rules. The domain knowledge is thus kept apart from movement and search procedures.
In an agent with 50 rules the rules can be added to the knowledge base and the same inference cycle can use the rules rather than have 50 different if clauses within the movement process.

3. Modus Ponens & Horn Clauses (Understand)
The rule `['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'] ⇒ 'SafeToEngage'` is formally known as a Horn Clause. Briefly explain how your Python implementation of the

`forward_chain()` `while` loop acts as a mathematical execution of the *Modus Ponens* inference rule.

"['TargetVisible', 'HasDust'] => 'SafeToEngage'" is a Horn clause since the conclusion holds true whenever all premises hold true. In the "forward_chain()" function the condition "all(premise in facts for premise in premises)" checks for the presence of all premises.
Once it checks out the conclusion is added to the list of facts. This represents Modus Ponens where premises, implication and the conclusion are used to draw an inference. Passing the loop repeatedly will enable one rule's conclusion to be another rule's premise.

Finalize and Lock Lab 07 Implementation

✅ **Lab 05 Theory-to-Implementation Mapping completed!**

FACULTY OF COMPUTING